

AFTER ACTION REVIEW OF UNDP CORPORATE RESPONSE TO THE CRISIS IN LEBANON

FINAL REPORT

December 2025

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

AAR	After Action Review
BCP	Business Continuity Plan
BERA	Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau for Management Support
BPPS	Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
C3RT	Crisis Readiness, Response, and Recovery Team
CB	Crisis Board
CMST	Crisis Management Support Team
CO	Country Office
DRM	Disaster Risk Management (Unit)
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
FW	Funding Window
GFFO	German Federal Foreign Office
GoL	Government of Lebanon
GPCR	Governance, Peacebuilding, Crisis and Resilience (Funding Window)
HDP	Humanitarian Development Peace Nexus
HQ	Headquarters
IDP	Internally Displaced Persons
IR	Inception Report
ISF	Internal Security Forces
KII	Key Informant Interview
LAF	Lebanese Armed Forces
LHSP	Lebanon Host Support Programme
LMAC	Lebanon Mine Action Centre
LRP	Lebanon Response Plan
MSME	Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises
PACP	Partnership and Communications in Crisis Action Plan
PIP	Project Initiation Plan
PMO	Prime Minister's Office
RBAS	Regional Bureau for Arab States
RM	Resource Mobilization
RR	Resident Representative
SM	Special Measures
SOPs	Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
SRM	Stabilization Response Mechanism
ToRs	Terms of Reference
UN	United Nations
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
USD	United States Dollars

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

UNDP CORPORATE RESPONSE TO THE CRISIS

STRATEGIC DECISIONS

Key strategic decisions were taken rapidly and effectively both at corporate and at country level. UNDP declared a Level 3 crisis at the first Crisis Board Meeting on 29 September 2024, and the Crisis Bureau allocated US\$1.2M in TRAC3 funding to the Country Office (CO), which was used for aid coordination, assessments, and a crisis response and stabilization programmatic package, plus additional resources through Funding Windows (FW) to implement the response. The decision to reinforce existing government-led coordination mechanisms rather than introduce new cluster structures was strategically sound and preserved national ownership while consolidating UNDP's central role across response, stabilization, and recovery planning.

Strategic decision-making benefited from a high-trust, decentralized corporate model that empowered a strong Country Office while providing timely political, technical, and operational backing. Corporate decisions to delegate authority and avoid micromanagement enabled agility, political sensitivity, risk-informed programming, and effective leveraging of corporate tools. The effectiveness of this approach, however, was contingent on the CO's demonstrated leadership, crisis experience, and operational maturity, so it cannot be universally applied in other crisis.

WHOLE OF UNDP APPROACH AND SOPS

Overall, the organization followed the Standard Operating Procedures for Crisis Response (SOPs) by immediately convening the Crisis Board meeting, undertaking immediate response actions, including the activation of the Business Continuity Plan (BCP), activating the Crisis Management Support Team (CMST), approving *ad-hoc* flexibility measures consistent with the Special Measures that were undergoing a corporate approval process, identifying SURGE experts for deployment. The organization clearly took a 'whole of UNDP' approach and came to support the CO in different ways.

The CO repeatedly underlined the extensive support, guidance and professionalism from the Crisis Bureau, the Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS) and the rest of the organization. There is a widespread recognition of the CO's technical and political capacity, which enabled a strong sense of trust that in turn facilitated the response.

LEVERAGING CORPORATE SUPPORT

The CO was able to leverage corporate programmatic, operational and financial support along three main dimensions: *Politically*, the CO used early and flexible resources (TRAC3 and FW) and the technical support of SURGE deployments, to reinforce national systems. *Technically*, the CO used corporate expertise to fulfil some capacity gaps: the assessments strengthened the CO's analytical reputation and gave a strong evidence base to the integrated Crisis Response & Stabilization Package. *Financially*, the CO turned early TRAC3 allocations of approximately US\$ 1.3 million into larger funding resources, mobilizing approximately US\$ 19 million for the crisis response and stabilization package and US\$ 30 million for the Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF) ecosystem project.

PROGRAMMATIC ASPECTS OF THE RESPONSE

UNDP's response to the crisis in Lebanon was articulated in the 5 components of the "Crisis Response and Stabilization Package": this was pertinent to the crisis context and generally timely, though it involved some trade-offs in design depth and faced implementation constraints, particularly in the South. The response focused on institutions and functions central to a compounded, state-led crisis

response, including the national DRM unit, first responders, local authorities, the Lebanese Armed Forces and Police, and the Lebanese Mine Action Centre. This closely matched a crisis characterized by large-scale displacement and widespread damage to housing, services and productive assets.

The integrated "Crisis Response and Stabilization Package" was an effective strategic framework for coherence, donor engagement, and internal alignment across crisis response, stabilization, and recovery. The package provided a clear narrative and structure linking assessments, programmatic shifts, stabilization logic, and resource mobilization. It enabled UNDP to present a credible, evidence-based offer to donors and to internally align multiple funding streams including TRAC3, Funding Windows and reprogrammed resources, in addition to the new resources mobilized.

SRM AND THE STABILIZATION PROGRAMME

The Stabilization Response Mechanism (SRM) was activated after the November 2024 Cessation of Hostilities Agreement; a joint scoping mission in February–March 2025 led to USD 3 million initial funding for 12 months for the Lebanon Stabilization programme. While initial mobilization was timely, protracted negotiations linked to the complementarity of GFFO and KfW/BMZ funding and continued insecurity in the South delayed implementation until July 2025. The intended speed advantage of stabilization programming through the SRM was partially lost due to these donor internal coordination challenges, integration complexities with development financing, and continued insecurity.

GENDER EQUALITY

At corporate and governance levels, gender is clearly recognized as a priority: SOPs explicitly require that 15% of allocations of crisis resources are assigned to GEN3 projects. The CO has a strong gender foundation, with a Gender Equality Strategy and recognition for its gender work (Silver Gender Seal), and gender considerations are integrated into programme designs and proposals. However, based on the information collected by the CO, the 15% GEN3 threshold was not reached collectively across the response, although it was reached in the Stabilization project. This reveals some gaps in translating corporate commitments into practice during rapid crisis response.

OPERATIONAL ASPECTS OF THE RESPONSE

Operational effectiveness was high overall, with some bottlenecks in HR surge, procurement thresholds, and SURGE deployment continuity. Special Measures, experienced operations staff, and proactive risk management enabled continuity and delivery under extremely difficult conditions. However, delays in HR processes through GSSC, limited delegation for non-staff recruitment, procurement constraints, and uneven SURGE profile matching reduced the efficiency gains expected from existing crisis mechanisms.

SPECIAL MEASURES

Special measures for Lebanon were formally approved on 30 September 2024 and extended to 31 December 2025, with most requested measures approved and consistent with corporate "pre-approved" provisions for declared crises. Finance arrangements enabled flexibility, though several contingency measures ultimately proved unnecessary. Human resources processes were more uneven: GSSC recruitment faced challenges in speed and quality, requiring repeated CO follow-up. Risk management, particularly around security and staff wellbeing, was central and effectively managed, with comprehensive support for physical safety, relocation, and psychosocial needs. Potential evacuation of international staff presented a challenge due to the absence of a common UN position, leaving individual Agencies to decide independently. UNDP ultimately reduced its footprint through flexible working arrangements and voluntary departures. The experience however highlights

the existing tension for UN agencies between duty of care towards staff and the principle of 'stay-and-deliver'.

SURGE

The CO was supported with three SURGE deployments: on assessments, mine action, and communications. SURGE deployments were relevant and provided continuity in priority areas, and where relationship already existed ensured a strong contextual fit that enabled the response. Some challenges in SURGE profile matching, continuity planning, and performance evaluation constrained its impact, revealing improvement opportunities.

RESOURCE MOBILIZATION AND PARTNERSHIPS

Overall, the CO was able to mobilize approximately US\$ 50.5 million for the crisis response and stabilization (including internal resources provided via TRAC3 and Funding Windows), which is a substantial achievement in the current funding climate.

Resource mobilization was effective and catalytic, and relied heavily on Country Office capacity rather than a corporate crisis-related resource mobilization architecture. This success was driven by the CO's capacity, credibility, analytical products, and donor relationships. Corporate RM support added value in positioning and visibility, but played a secondary role, highlighting the need for stronger, more systematic corporate engagement in crisis-related RM. This issue has been now addressed with a Partnership Lead role.

GOOD PRACTICES AND LESSONS LEARNED

Good practices identified include:

- Trust-based delegation to a high-capacity Country Office
- Reinforcing national coordination systems rather than creating parallel structures.
- Framing crisis response, stabilization and recovery within a single strategic narrative
- Prioritization of local expertise

Some **lessons** are learned through the Lebanon experience:

- Donor architecture risks must be anticipated and actively managed
- Rapid guidance is needed on evacuation and duty of care in high-risk contexts
- Crisis programming and operational flexibility require mindset shift and experience, or training and preparedness

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

CONCLUSIONS

The corporate response was highly relevant and strategically well positioned, successfully leveraging UNDP's comparative advantage in state-led crisis response, stabilization, and early recovery. UNDP's focus on national institutions, coordination systems, and state authority matched the nature of the Lebanon crisis and clearly differentiated its role from humanitarian actors.

Timeliness was strong at the strategic and early operational levels, but diminished during the transition from crisis response to stabilization due to structural and donor-related constraints. Early actions – including anticipatory support to the DRM unit, rapid declaration of an L3 crisis, early TRAC3 allocations, fast activation of SM – enabled UNDP to move quickly and credibly. Gender equality and surge deployment practices reveal some gaps in translating corporate commitments into practice.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Details on each recommendation are provided in the report.

For the Crisis Bureau

- Refine the SRM operational model
- Introduce mandatory performance and continuity requirements for SURGE deployments
- Conduct a cost-benefit or cost-effectiveness analysis across the last/next 7-10 crisis responses on the deployment of SURGE international staff
- Switch to national SURGE recruitment by default where conditions allow
- Develop a standard onboarding and offboarding protocol for deployment and support COs in implementing.
- In collaboration with BMS, develop practical guidance on evacuation.
- Replicate standard emergency practice and develop Crisis Preparedness Plans.
- Conduct a refresher training to all CO (particularly Project/Programme Managers) on the Gender Marker Guidance Note
- Develop enforcing mechanisms to ensure the implementation of the 15% allocation of crisis resources to GEN3 outputs

For BERA

- Maintain proactive corporate RM engagement in L3 crises, even where CO capacity is strong
- Ensure coordination of crisis communications support follows the Crisis SOPs

For BMS

- In collaboration with the Crisis Bureau, develop practical guidance on evacuation
- Strengthen Special Measures implementation

For Lebanon CO

- Strengthen gender responsiveness beyond mainstreaming by increasing targeted GEN3 interventions in crisis portfolio.
- Develop a crisis preparedness plan for likely risk scenarios, and operating under heightened security and access constraints

INTRODUCTION

In October 2023, hostilities between Hezbollah and Israel erupted, triggered by the Gaza war. Fighting escalated sharply in September 2024, leading to intensified airstrikes across southern Lebanon, Beirut's southern suburbs, and the Bekaa. A ceasefire was brokered in November 2024. The conflict caused extensive destruction, particularly in the South of Lebanon: over 64,000 buildings damaged or destroyed, critical infrastructure including power, roads, and water systems heavily hit, widespread debris and rubble left in urban centers, and large areas contaminated by unexploded ordnance (UXO). More than 1.2 million people were displaced, and recovery needs were estimated at around US\$11 billions.

UNDP declared a Level 3 crisis at the first Crisis Board Meeting on 29 September 2024, and the Crisis Bureau allocated US\$1.2M in TRAC3 funding to the Country Office (CO), which was used for aid coordination, assessments, and a crisis response and stabilization programmatic package, plus additional resources through Funding Windows (FW) to implement the response. Three SURGE Advisors were deployed and several Bureaus (including for example the Crisis Bureau, BERA, BMS, RBAS and others) supported the CO in the crisis response. The L3 crisis was closed after 6 months, in April 2025. The collective organizational effort and its results are the subject of the present light After Action Review (AAR).

AAR GOALS, SCOPE AND METHODOLOGY

The goal of the AAR is to conduct a structured reflection on the crisis response to identify strengths and weaknesses, lessons learned and good practices, to sustain and multiply what was done well, and to identify and correct areas for improvement. The present AAR, designed as a light exercise, covers the period of the activation of the corporate response to the Lebanon crisis from its beginning in September 2024 to the closure in April 2025. It analyzes the key areas covered in the Terms of Reference (ToRs), which include:

Overall clarity and timeliness of decision making for the response

Effectiveness of the operational response

Timeliness and effectiveness of programmatic response and Corporate Funds

Resource mobilization and partnerships

Some elements have been identified during inception as being of particular interest, including the programmatic response and particularly the Stabilization Response Mechanism (SRM), the application of Special Measures (SM) and resource mobilization and partnership.

The methodology is described in more detail in [Annex 2](#).

ANALYSIS OF THE LEBANON CRISIS RESPONSE

UNDP CORPORATE RESPONSE TO THE CRISIS

STRATEGIC DECISIONS

Key strategic decisions were taken rapidly and effectively both at corporate and at country level. The table below summarizes the key decisions and their impact.

Strategic decisions	Description and effects
Declaration of L3 crisis, full support and trust to Lebanon CO	UNDP declared an L3 corporate emergency for Lebanon , with funding and support for six months, and approved special measures for one year (which were later extended to the end of 2025). Since the beginning and throughout the crisis, the leadership, technical and political capacity and experience of the CO were recognized by all, enabling the necessary trust for the CO to lead the response, including on sensitive issues, and to implement a large portfolio quickly and with considerable autonomy and operational flexibility.
Positioning of UNDP as a key actor across crisis response, stabilization, and recovery, and support of the existing coordination system	Strategically, UNDP aimed to be a key actor from the beginning of the response: supporting government coordination during the crisis, leading on assessments and data management, playing a central role in stabilization and preparing the ground for future recovery. This included supporting the Disaster Risk Management (DRM) Unit at the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) and other first responders, leading assessments on the socio-economic impact of the conflict and specifically on the impact on municipalities, using the assessments to shape macro-economic narratives and recovery portfolios; and aligning its programmatic offer accordingly, through a comprehensive package of crisis response and stabilization. In parallel, UNDP successfully defended the existing crisis coordination system against the push for a new cluster arrangement, an intelligent choice since the existing system worked, had strong government ownership, and engaged both local and national authorities. This avoided duplication and fragmentation, and maintained UNDP's central role in coordination, thanks to a coordinated effort both at country level and at headquarters level in interagency fora.
Adoption of an integrated "Crisis Response and Stabilization Package" as the overarching programmatic and resource mobilization framework	UNDP adopted a comprehensive "Crisis Response & Stabilization Package"¹ with five components, for an estimated total of about US\$81.7M, which was the programmatic reference for all interventions, guiding the immediate response as well as stabilization and early recovery interventions, and providing a clear framework for resource mobilization. In particular, three elements emerge as strategically important: • The support provided (even before the declaration of the L3 crisis) to the DRM Unit at the Prime Minister's Office, with consultants, equipment, and data systems. This unit allowed UNDP to have "<i>the pulse of the whole crisis response</i>", while operating behind the scenes with technical capacity and resources, and preserving national ownership of the response coordination. • The support to the Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF), linked to UNSC Resolution 1701 and to the cessation of hostilities in the South of the country. The strategic goal of the project is to extend state authority in southern Lebanon and thus promote stabilization; in collaboration with France and with the full backing of HQ, the project was included in the Paris Conference agenda, giving it great visibility and anchoring civil-military stabilization in the overall response. • The comprehensive approach to stabilization, which included the design and implementation of a Stabilization project with the support of the joint Stabilization Response Mechanism (SRM) jointly created by UNDP and the German Federal Foreign Office (GFFO). The project focused on three pillars: security in communities; infrastructure rehabilitation and service delivery, and income support.

WHOLE OF UNDP APPROACH AND SOPS

Overall, the organization followed the **Standard Operating Procedures for Crisis Response (SOPs)** by immediately convening the Crisis Board meeting, undertaking immediate crisis readiness actions, including the activation of the Business Continuity Plan (BCP), activating the Crisis Management Support Team (CMST), approving flexibility measures, identifying SURGE experts for deployment.

¹ The Crisis Response and Stabilization Package is described more in detail in the chapter on the "Programmatic aspects of the response".

The organization clearly took a **‘whole of UNDP’ approach** and came to support the CO in different ways:

- **Regional framing of the crisis.** The crisis was seen as inherently regional, which led to joint Crisis Board and CMST meetings; the latter in particular covered both Lebanon and Syria, reflecting the cross-border impact of the crisis. They allowed both COs share updates, understand each other’s challenges, and identify potential programming synergies. One key informant observed, however, that since the focus at the time was on Lebanon – due to the gravity of the situation – the expectations of Syria CO might have not been fully met, especially in terms of financial support.² No downsides were identified for Lebanon in this joint approach.
- **Quality of corporate support: trust, speed, and “not being alone”.** The CO repeatedly underlined the extensive support, guidance and professionalism from the Crisis Bureau, the Regional Bureau for Arab States (RBAS), the Bureau for Management Services (BMS) and the Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA). There is a widespread recognition of the CO’s technical and political capacity, which enabled a strong sense of trust in the CO; approvals and funding were fast and the CO was not micromanaged but appropriately supported.
- **Political support and joint HQ/CO action on key issues.** Senior management at Headquarters (HQ) and in the Country Office worked together, each at their own level, to successfully advocate for maintaining the existing in-country coordination structure rather than introducing a new cluster system; corporate messaging reinforced UNDP’s stance in different fora to support the national architecture instead of creating parallel mechanisms. The CO and UNDP Senior Management also coordinated closely and successfully to ensure that UNDP’s project supporting the Lebanese Armed Forces was prominently positioned at the Paris Conference and clearly linked to both the immediate crisis response and the country’s long-term stability.

Each Bureau provided tailored support:

Crisis Bureau	RBAS
Sustained support from the Crisis Bureau. The Crisis Bureau provided early support to the CO and continued throughout the crisis, including: • Providing a TRAC3 allocation of US\$ 170,000 in September, ahead of the L3 crisis declaration, to strengthen the national DRM unit with consultants and equipment for data analysis and preparedness; • Supporting rapid assessment with satellite imagery and geospatial analysis of areas affected by Israeli attacks through the SURGE Data Hub; • TRAC3 allocation of US\$ 1,200,000 for coordination, assessments and immediate response; • Funding Window allocations to complement funding for the Stabilization Programme; • SURGE support through remote and in-country deployments of experts on assessments, mine action, and communications; • Remote technical support on the different crisis response packages available; • Deployment of the Stabilization Response Mechanism (SRM) for the design and kick-off of the stabilization project in country;	RBAS acted as the corporate entry point, with a clear principle of CO primacy in decisions and avoiding micromanagement. RBAS worked with the CO on both staff safety/security and on the programmatic response. The Regional Director in his Beirut visit helped secure a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on aid coordination with the PM’s Office, reinforcing UNDP’s role in supporting the DRM unit and its role in institutional capacity-building of national entities.

² This aspect will be explored in a subsequent After Action Review focused on Syria crisis, planned for Q1 2026.

• Together with BMS, approval of Lebanon-specific special measures³ to augment operational flexibility and speed for the crisis response and the stabilization project. It should be noted that the Crisis Readiness, Response, and Recovery Team (C3RT) Arab States Team Lead already knew Lebanon well from previous deployments and from having worked in the CO, which contributed to an in-depth understanding of the context and programmes of the CO, and to the sustained, rapid and effective support to the CO.	
BERA	BMS
BERA provided support on resource mobilization and communications by organizing a donor briefing with 18 missions, integrating Lebanon messages into corporate crisis messaging, and maintaining monthly coordination calls with the CO, divisions and bureaus to align corporate action on RM and communications with needs on the ground. Some informants have observed that BERA involvement was limited. In line the SOPs and C-PACP, the engagement of BERA is determined by the CO, and it is worth observing that the CO did not request support on RM and was able to develop proposal and pursue funding with its own capacities. Another challenge identified was around communications: inputs from multiple corporate roles was not initially streamlined, and the SURGE deployment arrived later. This may indicate that in areas where UNDP's internal coordination architecture is more fluid, the support provided to the CO may be less effective.⁴	BMS swiftly approved special measures for Lebanon for one year, and later extended them to the end of 2025. It also provided guidance on safety and security of the staff and on the potential evacuation of international personnel remaining in country.⁵

LEVERAGING CORPORATE SUPPORT

All stakeholders consulted unanimously agree that the CO has strong leadership, programmatic and operational capacities and that the response was largely CO-led. The CO was able to leverage corporate programmatic, operational and financial support along three main dimensions: political, technical and financial.

Politically, the CO used early and flexible resources (TRAC3 and FW) and the technical support of SURGE deployments, to reinforce national systems. By continuing to invest in the DRM unit and in first responders during the crisis, the CO maintained its role as key partner for crisis coordination. Similarly, it successfully defended maintaining the nationally-led coordination system against a shift towards a cluster model, with the result that UNDP remained at the centre of a government-owned architecture. On the stabilization side, the support towards the Armed Forces and Internal Security Forces (ISF, the Police) and the design and implementation of the stabilization project in the South anchored UNDP's security and governance work into UNSC Resolution 1701, strengthening its political role on state authority and the long-term stability of the country.

Technically, the CO used corporate expertise to fulfil some capacity gaps: the post-war assessments, to which UNDP corporate support contributed both technically and financially, strengthened the CO's analytical reputation and policy voice; in addition, they gave a strong evidence base to the integrated Crisis Response & Stabilization Package. Moreover, specialized mine action support via SURGE deployments bolstered the CO support of the Lebanon Mine Action Centre (LMAC), while the technical support provided through the SRM helped design and kickstart the stabilization programme.

³ UNDP has a set of "Pre-approved special measures for crisis response" which are automatically applicable to all countries in an L-classified crisis. At the time of the conflict in Lebanon, these measures were undergoing peer review, therefore specific measures were approved for Lebanon, very similar to the current "Pre-approved" ones.

⁴ Communications is not included in the scope of the AAR.

⁵ This matter is discussed with some more detail under the Operations chapter.

Financially, the CO turned early TRAC3 allocations of approximately US\$ 1,3 million into larger funding resources, mobilizing approximately US\$ 19 million for the crisis response and stabilization package (of which around US\$ 4 millions dedicated to the stabilization programme⁶), and US\$ 30 million for the LAF ecosystem project.⁷ The assessments, the technical expertise of the CO and SURGE support, and the track record of the CO fostered an evidence-based, structured narrative on socio-economic impact and social cohesion that donors could buy into; within the current funding climate and concurrent crises, the mobilization of resources for Lebanon can be considered successful.

PROGRAMMATIC ASPECTS OF THE RESPONSE

UNDP's response to the crisis in Lebanon was articulated in the 5 components of the **"Crisis Response and Stabilization Package"**:

1. Strengthen crisis management and response capacities of first responders at the national and local levels.
2. Extend basic service delivery (focusing on energy and solid waste) and boost local capacities to manage the displacement crisis.
3. Provide immediate income generation and stabilization of livelihoods and productive sector.
4. Mitigate the impact of conflict escalation and maintain social stability in Lebanon through conflict prevention, peacebuilding, and security service provision.
5. Ensure urgent support to Lebanese Armed Forces families impacted by the escalation of hostilities in support of SC Resolution 1701 implementation.

ASSESSMENTS

UNDP's made an intentional effort to position itself as a **knowledge and analytical actor**, rapidly delivering **key assessments such as the Rapid Impact Assessment on municipalities⁸, and the Socio-Economic Impact Assessment (SEIA)**. These assessments directly informed crisis response and stabilization programming and resource mobilization; the Rapid Impact Assessment was rapidly implemented considering the persistent insecurity and access challenges in the areas affected by the conflict: it surveyed 135 affected localities in December 2024, shortly after the ceasefire. It provided a systematic picture of displacement and of damage to housing, businesses, agriculture and local infrastructure. As it was conducted while decisions on recovery priorities and funding were still being shaped, stakeholders were able to use the results immediately to inform programming and advocacy. The SEIA report was less timely, being published in July 2025; its preliminary findings were shared to inform programme design and resource mobilization.

The methodologies used combined a rigorous approach with the pragmatic adaptations needed in a challenging context. The municipal impact assessment relied on self-reporting by municipalities and unions, supported by governorate Disaster Risk Management units and mobile data collection tools. This approach was useful where UNDP access was limited and promoted local ownership of the data. The SEIA, a joint effort with other UN agencies, used a structured approach combining multiple field surveys which produced detailed results useful to design targeted, evidence-based recovery initiatives and strengthened the credibility of related funding proposals. Both assessments also fed directly into national coordination efforts, supporting the national DRM unit in its response coordination efforts. Their findings were systematically used to reprioritize and design programmes, including targeting the most affected municipalities for infrastructure and basic services, retargeting activities within UNDP's

⁶ As the stabilization programme has only recently started implementation, it is too early to assess its future resource mobilization potential.

⁷ See the chapter on [Resource Mobilization](#) for more details.

⁸ UNDP (2025), From Crisis to Recovery: Local Authorities Confronting Post-War Realities in Lebanon. Rapid Impact Assessment

portfolio, including on agriculture, livelihoods, MSMEs and local governance, and integrating alternative energy and crisis communication into local support.⁹

PROGRAMME ADJUSTMENTS

Adjustments to the CO portfolio focused on **rapidly reorienting ongoing programmes and capacities toward the crisis**, while at the same time designing new stabilization-oriented initiatives. The CO conducted a quick skills mapping of staff and reorganized tasks so that those with relevant experience could move into crisis support roles. This internal reallocation addressed operational needs and responded to staff willingness to contribute, which helped maintain morale.

Programmatically, existing funds and activities were repurposed wherever possible for the crisis response: basic services interventions were shifted geographically to follow population movements and target communities receiving high numbers of displaced people, including in locations not originally planned, thanks to donor flexibility. Within the Lebanon Host Community Support Project (LHSP), some activities were retargeted, including reallocating funds to strengthen civil defence and supporting MSMEs to adapt production lines to crisis-relevant items. At local level, communication support to municipalities was reoriented toward crisis communication. Within the Green Inclusive Development portfolio, schools scheduled for solarization were reprioritized so that those serving as shelters for internally displaced people (IDPs) were treated first, providing immediate energy benefits during displacement and leaving a lasting asset once schools resume normal use.

PERTINENCE AND TIMELINESS OF THE PROGRAMMATIC RESPONSE

UNDP's programmatic response in Lebanon was **pertinent to the crisis context and generally timely**, though it involved trade-offs in design depth and faced implementation constraints, particularly in the South.

The response focused on institutions and functions central to a compounded, state-led crisis response, including the national DRM unit, first responders, local authorities, the Lebanese Armed Forces and Police, and the Lebanese Mine Action Centre. This closely matched a crisis characterized by large-scale displacement and widespread damage to housing, services and productive assets. Support to the DRM unit, aid coordination and assessments was especially relevant, positioning UNDP at the center of information flows and planning across immediate response, stabilization and recovery. Interventions on energy solutions, debris and waste management, livelihoods, income generation and local productivity were also well **aligned with UNDP's comparative advantage in crisis settings**.

The LAF ecosystem initiative was particularly pertinent to stabilization, linking the welfare and operational readiness of the Armed Forces, including food security and social services for LAF families, to broader state stability and confidence in public institutions. Both the LAF and stabilization projects carried some risk of criticism given the scale of humanitarian needs. However, UNDP's focus on institutions reflects its mandate and comparative advantage, while traditional humanitarian assistance can be led by other actors. This approach nonetheless requires careful communication to ensure that support to security and coordination structures is understood as enabling community protection and service delivery, rather than diverting attention and resources from urgent humanitarian needs.

The CO mobilized rapidly, drawing on experience from previous crises. Existing coordination mechanisms and programmes from the refugee, economic and COVID-19 crises allowed a swift shift to full crisis mode, while ongoing work on DRM, social stability and local governance was quickly adapted and where relevant, retargeted to IDP-hosting areas. Support to the DRM unit was requested even before the L3 declaration, reflecting the anticipatory capacity of the CO. It took a while, however,

⁹ For an analysis of their gender dimensions, please refer to the chapter on [Gender equality](#).

to develop a Concept Note or a Project Initiation Plan (PIP), which is required documentation for TRAC3 allocations. The LAF ecosystem project, launched in December 2024, was timely and well positioned to support implementation of the cessation of hostilities and sustained LAF engagement in the South.

Some trade-offs accompanied this rapid mobilization, as parts of the project design relied on lighter analysis than would normally be preferred, slightly reducing the depth of programme formulation. The stabilization scoping mission took place in February/March 2025, with a draft project ready by the end of March, but protracted negotiations linked to the complementarity of GFFO and existing KfW/BMZ funding and continued insecurity in the South delayed implementation until July. While initial mobilization was timely, these constraints have limited the CO’s ability to scale up into rapid and visible impact of stabilization for affected populations.

SRM AND THE STABILIZATION PROGRAMME

The Stabilization Response Mechanism (SRM) is a global UNDP–GFFO tool that provides rapid scoping, technical support and seed funding to develop a stabilization project when a political window opens. In Lebanon, the SRM was activated after the November 2024 Cessation of Hostilities Agreement; a joint scoping mission in February–March 2025 from UNDP-GFFO and with the Lebanon CO led to USD 3 million initial funding for 12 months for the Lebanon Stabilization programme, focusing on South and Nabatiyeh governorates, and built around UNDP’s three pillar stabilization model: community security through LAF and ISF presence, rapid rehabilitation of key infrastructure and services, and short-term income support, all deployed together to extend legitimate state authority in areas long influenced by non-state actors, and to enable returns.

The SRM and the stabilization programme present both successes and challenges:

Successes and opportunities		Challenges	
Context	Seizing a narrow political window. The SRM enabled UNDP and GFFO to move politically and programmatically in the immediate aftermath of the ceasefire. The scoping mission and project design were conducted in a few weeks – which informants highlight is a short timeframe for this kind of projects - to ensure the project would be immediately initiated, taking advantage of the opportunity available. In UNDP’s model, stabilization is time-bound and it is expected to be soon followed by regular programming, which is why it usually has a 12-18 months timeframe.	Security and access constraints in the South. Continued airstrikes and insecurity in southern Lebanon have limited access to frontline areas, generated uncertainty among communities and national counterparts, and delayed implementation.	
	(UNDP’s) Working in politically-sensitive areas, controlled or heavily influenced by non-state actors. The stabilization project fills a gap by accepting political and reputational risk in operating in areas controlled or heavily influenced by non-state actors, where traditional development tools and many humanitarian instruments are blocked by due diligence or neutrality constraints. Anchoring activities in Governors’ offices and DRM units, using only Government logos, and synchronising investments with LAF and ISF deployments aims at ensuring that credit goes to the state, not to UNDP or to non-state actors.	(Donor’s) Donor risk-aversion and earmarking restricted the model. According to some informants, there was some hesitation on the part of the donor to engage in the most politically-sensitive locations, even though stabilization logic requires working where state authority is weakest. Internal divergence between different branches of the donor architecture led to a reluctance to finance the income support pillar with GFFO funding, thus earmarking resources for only two pillars and forcing UNDP to contribute with additional resources. This issue shall be clarified in view of future iterations of the stabilization model in other countries with a similar funding base (KfW/BMZ and GFFO). ¹⁰	

¹⁰ In December 2025, Germany announced a restructuring of GFFO and the humanitarian budget is expected to be cut approximately 50% , which may impact the SRM replenishment and future activities. As German SRM funding might reduce or end because of restructuring inside GFFO, it will be important to broaden UNDP capacity to look at alternative mechanisms that support the country office in the development

Programmatic integration	Broader stabilization approach and portfolio integration. The stabilization project was conceived from the outset as part of the comprehensive “Crisis Response and Stabilization Package” and is part of a broader stabilization approach that also includes support to LAF and ISF and coordinates with other initiatives on local development funded by KfW/BMZ.	Integration with BMZ/KfW funded projects was over ambitious. Efforts to integrate GFFO SRM funding with BMZ/KfW local development funding created complexity and delays because objectives, methodologies and timelines of the two initiatives differ. UNDP ultimately had to use additional FW resources of approximately 1M to ensure all three pillars of the stabilization model could be implemented together, and specifically to fund the third pillar. Ideally, stabilization should come first and at speed, while BMZ and KfW local development support could be sequenced at a later stage, to consolidate the results achieved. This could have not happened in Lebanon as the stabilization window opened after the local development project was agreed, but it is a lesson to keep in mind for future iterations of the stabilization model, that the actual situation on the ground might require additional flexibility and deviation from the model. In cases like these, close coordination with BERA may help moderate or resolve coordination challenges within the donor government
Corporate practice	Clear stabilization logic and alignment with corporate practice. The Lebanon project applies UNDP’s corporate three pillar model with a clear theory of change: visible state security, rapid service and infrastructure repair, and temporary income support working together to rebuild trust in the state and reduce reliance on non-state actors. Use of existing CO mechanisms. The project takes advantage of the existing Tensions Monitoring System (TMS) for trust and perception indicators, an efficient choice that allows stabilization monitoring to piggyback on already established mechanisms.	Organizational mindset. Some informants have highlighted how the stabilization approach demands a different way of working: fewer consultations, higher risk-appetite, no branding, faster decisions, and how this shift might have not been fully absorbed in all parts of the organization. In addition, limited human resources, multiple competing priorities and staff changes in key operational functions such as procurement slowed implementation.
SRM model	Comprehensive package support. The SRM proved to be an effective mechanism as it does not only contribute technical expertise, corporate guidance, training and lessons from other contexts, but also funding and a solid relationship with the donor, cultivated over time, all elements that contribute to the swift deployment and design of stabilization projects.¹¹ The availability of seed funding within the SRM, in particular, removes an additional step in negotiating for resources with a donor and allows for the rapid implementation, critical for the success of the stabilization approach.	Speed and process fell short of the model. Despite the SRM being intended as a rapid mechanism, it took roughly seven months from the ceasefire to the project start. Initial drafts were prepared quickly after the scoping mission, but the subsequent process took longer, mostly due to the difficulty of integrating different approaches between the stabilization and the local development models, and donor internal negotiations and validation. Implementation effectively started at the end of August and it is still too early to assess results. For an instrument that is supposed to be fast and catalytic, this delay is significant and diluted some of the advantage of pre-positioned funding.
Resource mobilization	Immediate funding. The SRM was able to provide US\$ 3M for the stabilization project, which were complemented by a FW allocation of USD 935,000 to ensure concurrent implementation of the three pillars (UNDP funding particularly was allocated to pillar three)	Sustainability and scale beyond the proof of concept. The Lebanon project is framed as a 12 month proof of concept, yet government counterparts already express strong interest in continuation. A challenge ahead is to secure financing and political support to scale stabilization interventions, especially within the current austere funding climate, and avoid a sharp end when SRM funds finish or creating unrealistic expectations

of a consolidated donor proposal and engagement strategy responding to the crisis at hand. In line with current SOPs, the Country Office should remain in the lead, working closely with BERA and RBAS.

¹¹ In the case of Lebanon delays in the final design were experienced due to the concomitant funding on local development by another German funding entity, and the subsequent negotiations to integrate the two approaches or make them complementary. This is not inherent to the SRM or the stabilization approach, but rather related to the specific case of Lebanon funding. This issue is further discussed in the following section on challenges.

about what a short-term mechanism can sustain on its own.

GENDER EQUALITY

At corporate and governance levels, gender is clearly recognized as a priority: gender responsiveness is raised and within Crisis Board discussions; SOPs explicitly require that **15% of allocations of crisis resources are assigned to projects whose principal objective (consistent with existing mandates) is to address women's specific needs, advance gender equality or empower women**, a commitment formally acknowledged in the exigency memo.

The CO has a strong gender foundation: it has a Gender Equality Strategy focused on inclusive governance, economy and justice; it has also received recognition for its gender work (Silver Gender Seal) and it has internal gender expertise and gender consultants financed through crisis response resources.

Gender in assessments. Across the two assessments, gender is treated differently. The Rapid Impact Assessment on municipalities, conducted by UNDP, is essentially gender blind: it concentrates on municipalities, displacement and damage to housing, businesses, agriculture and infrastructure, providing geographic and sectoral breakdowns but does not consider the differential impact on women, men, girls and boys. For example, the damage to schools, health facilities or water facilities will have a different impact on each of these groups and on their opportunities for recovery; disaggregated data could have been useful. Similarly, identifying the number or proportion of business establishments damaged or destroyed that were utilized mostly or exclusively by women or belonged to female business-owners could have provided useful information for subsequent programme design. Data reported on IDPs is not disaggregated by sex.

By contrast, the report on the socioeconomic impacts (conducted by ESCWA, UNDP, UNICEF, ILO, UN-Habitat) integrates a gender lens. It recognises that the war has deepened gender inequalities, presents sex and age disaggregated figures for deaths and injuries, and shows how women's employment has been hit harder than men's due to care burdens, mobility constraints, sectoral segregation and exposure to GBV. It also highlights different impacts on girls and boys in education and child labour, notes the specific loss of income for rural women dependent on non-wood forest products, and draws on an external rapid gender analysis of displaced adolescent girls and young women. It recommends gender responsive policy directions such as targeted social protection and employment measures for women and young people.

In terms of **programme design**, gender considerations are integrated to a certain extent into programme designs and proposals, including in the crisis response programme, in the LAF ecosystem programme and in stabilization. GEN marking across all outputs reflects a preponderance of gender mainstreaming particularly at institutional and systems levels. However, GEN1 and GEN2 dominance suggests limited targeting of women and girls as primary beneficiaries.

Project	Output	GEN code	Amounts budgeted in ProDocs
Furthering a stronger and more focused engagement of the Lebanese Armed Forces (LAF) through support to the livelihood "ecosystem" of its service members.	Enhanced well-being and food security of LAF services members families	GEN1	49.857.420
	Strengthened access to quality social services to vulnerable LAF families	GEN1	22.679.211
	Enhanced operational readiness of the LAF	GEN1	10.924.951
	Strengthened Civil-Military Cooperation (CIMIC) capacities to support stabilization, recovery, and renewed trust in State institutions	GEN2	25.000.000

	Ensured effective management and implementation	not coded	2.649.528
Mitigating the impact of conflict escalation in Lebanon on social, economic and institutional stability	Strengthened crisis management and response capacities of first responders at the national and local levels	GEN2	12.000.000
	Extended basic service delivery and boosted local capacities to manage the displacement crisis	GEN2	25.000.000
	Immediate income generation and stabilization of livelihoods and productive sector provided	GEN2	10.700.000
	Impact of conflict escalation mitigated and social stability maintained through conflict prevention, peacebuilding, and security service provision	GEN2	10.188.000
Stabilization in Southern Lebanon	Minimum security conditions created	GEN2	2.406.127
	Socio-productive infrastructure rehabilitated/reconstructed enabling state service delivery	GEN1	1.519.356
	Income support provided to vulnerable populations, such as returnees, female-headed households and youth at risk	GEN3	1.102.792

Specific commitments include, among others:

- Gender advisory support to DRM and civil defence institutions.
- Capacity building of civil defence to recognize and respond to gender-specific needs.
- Development of guiding principles for gender-sensitive data collection and community engagement in DRM.
- Support for women responders and women's participation in coordination mechanisms.

The crisis SOPs and UNDP gender policy require **that 15% of resources are allocated to GEN3 outputs**. Based on the information collected by the CO, this threshold was not reached collectively, although it was reached in the Stabilization project.

Out of the approximately US\$50,5 million mobilized, allocations to GEN3 activities include US\$ 400,000 under Output 4 of the crisis response project (approximately 2,9%) and US\$ 689,000 under Output 3 of the Stabilization project (17,32%). No GEN3 allocations were reported for the LAF ecosystem project.¹²

SURGE deployments. The ToRs of the three SURGE Advisors include gender equality aspects: all three roles are explicitly required to ensure gender-responsiveness or gender mainstreaming in their respective areas. The assessment role is clearly mandated to mainstream gender in the assessment and in the way follow-up programmes are designed. The Crisis Comms and Mine Action ToRs mention tailor-made messages and activities for women, and mainstreaming gender in mine action strategies and communications. Overall, the focus is on inclusion and sensitivity rather than structural change. In terms of outcomes, gender is integrated as a quality standard for main deliverables (assessment, strategies, frameworks, communications), but there are no standalone gender outputs such as a dedicated gender analysis report, gender action plan, or specific capacity development package on gender. The deliverables made available for this review vary in their inclusion of substantive gender components: Communications products contain few explicit references to gender, despite internal recognition of its importance; mine action documentation reviewed does not reference gender, although the SURGE expert has a background in developing gender guidelines for the mine action sector. The uneven inclusion of gender in assessments has been discussed earlier. All SURGE Advisors were men – this has been in part related to the scarcity of women in certain technical areas (like mine action), however that is not the case for communications and assessments.

OPERATIONAL ASPECTS OF THE RESPONSE

¹² According to UNDP guidance, the Gender Marker scoring is assigned to outputs, not activities. In the case of Lebanon projects this is reflected in the table above. However, the CO has also highlighted how funding has been allocated to activities classified as GEN3 under Output 4 of the crisis response project and under Output 3 in the Stabilization project (respectively USD 400,000 and USD 689,000).

The **operational response was timely and largely effective**, underpinned by early activation of the Business Continuity Plan (BCP), multiple measures to ensure the safety and security of staff and the rapid relocation of non-essential personnel. The CO was able to maintain **operational continuity** while simultaneously serving as a key operational service provider for other UN agencies (for example OCHA). This dual internal and external responsibility added to the workload but was managed well, reflecting the experience of the country office, the strong staffing and operational capacity, and the utility of the special measures, all elements which helped minimize many of the challenges typically associated with conflict settings. Additional operational support from the Crisis Bureau was described as excellent, with express roster hiring in particular contributing positively to surge capacity.

According to key informants, **procurement** and supply chain management represented the most significant challenge, especially during the height of the war, due to market disruptions and uncertainty. The main mitigation strategy was to rely on the local market and on an existing database of reliable suppliers, which limited the delays. The Special Measures proved helpful, allowing timelines to be adjusted and several Long Term Agreements (LTAs) to be extended. Overall, procurement is considered to have worked relatively well under the circumstances (which included a change of the Head of Procurement in recent months).

Finance arrangements were put in place to enable flexibility under crisis conditions, but in the end many of the contingency measures proved not necessary and were not used.

Human resources processes were more uneven: recruitment through the Global Shared Services Centre (GSSC) faced challenges, particularly in terms of speed and quality of the support. Repeated follow up from the CO was required, reminding that crisis procedures were in effect. For example, in three recruitment processes revised, a period of 10 days passed before finalization of the longlist by GCCS, and in two instances it took between 10 and 15 days to post the vacancy announcement after submitting the request for recruitment (Special Measures approved for Lebanon establish a fast-track processing of 3 days for personnel recruitment). These delays were seen as limiting the responsiveness of the HR function during the emergency.

Risk management, particularly around security and staff wellbeing, was a central and effectively managed component of the immediate response. Security support was described as critical and comprehensive, addressing physical safety, relocation, entitlements, and psychosocial support for staff operating under continuous threat. The main challenge was related to a decision on **evacuation** of international staff in the early days of the crisis, due to the lack of a common UN position, which left each Agency to decide for themselves. According to the UNSMS policy, the decision on evacuation is taken by the Security Management Team (SMT) and the Designated Official (DO), and approved by DSS Under-Secretary General; in absence of such a decision, individual agencies can lower their footprint with different options, including Alternate Work Modalities (AWM).

This situation represented a challenge: early in the crisis evacuation was considered, but there was not a common UN decision, which left the responsibility to find solutions with individual Agencies. While guidance is technically clear in terms of formal authority, these kind of decisions have multiple implications (security, safety, entitlements, cost, risk, and others) and therefore practical guidance would be useful on the options available. As the case of Lebanon it is not an isolated one, and in fact similar situations occur with increasing frequency,¹³ it is advisable that UNDP develops – if not existing already – quick practical guidance on exceptional security situations and disseminates it to the key staff in charge of such decisions in Country Offices, Regional Bureaux and HQ. In the end, UNDP used flexible working arrangements and voluntary departures, and full evacuation was not needed. The experience also highlighted a broader tension between duty of care towards staff and the principle of ‘stay-and-deliver’.

SPECIAL MEASURES

¹³ Recent examples made by key informants include Afghanistan, Ukraine, Sudan, Gaza.

Special measures for Lebanon were formally approved on 30 September 2024 for one year and later extended to 31 December 2025. Most of the measures requested by Lebanon were approved, with a few exceptions (notably a shorter solicitation period for procurement bids¹⁴). They are consistent with the corporate “pre approved” special measures¹⁵ that automatically apply in an L-level crisis. A table with details of the special measures utilized is included in [Annex 04](#).

What went well	Limitations
• Effectiveness. The special measures are considered very useful and effective by the CO. • Real operational acceleration. Fast tracked procurement reviews, higher cash limits and extended LTAs allowed the CO to move quickly on urgent goods, works and services for the response and stabilization portfolio. HR flexibilities made it possible to recruit quickly and to provide recruitment services to other UN entities, particularly for national surge, which is an appropriate and cost effective measure in Lebanon. • Experienced CO that knows how to use flexibilities. Lebanon’s operations team is very familiar with crisis tools; they identified needed measures early, applied them proactively and used the flexibility to support both UNDP and sister agencies.	• HR measures. The CO highlighted how agreed fast-track timelines for advertising and longlisting were not consistently met at GSSC level and required repeated follow-up, which limited the actual speed gains. • Limited delegation for non-staff recruitment. Around 80 % of personnel in Lebanon are non-staff, yet National Personal Service Agreements (NPSA) and similar modalities remain largely handled by GSSC. For crisis response, where non-staff are the main recruitment category, this may become a bottleneck; delegation of NPSA recruitment to the country level would enhance efficiency. • Constraints in procurement and finance. The request to shorten solicitation periods from 14 to 7 days was not approved, however, according to the CO this would significantly accelerate the procurement cycle, enabling faster supplier engagement and timely delivery of goods and services for urgent, time-bound activities. BMS indicates that the minimal gains in time are not compensated by the risk of not receiving sufficient high-quality bids, proved in previous analysis conducted around this measure (see footnote 14 above). Payments above USD 5,000 dollars require GSSC approval, which is viewed as too low a threshold in a large crisis portfolio and can delay disbursements.

SURGE

The CO was supported with [three SURGE deployments](#): on assessments, mine action, and communications.

Successes	Challenges
Relevance and continuity in priority areas. SURGE support was requested and mobilised quickly in key areas, particularly mine action, where the deployment was preceded by a one-month secondment from another agency. This helped sustain UNDP position as a central actor in mine action coordination during the crisis, contributed to securing new funding and to the strengthening of coordination mechanisms. Communications support was also relevant as the CO was in the process of hiring a Head of Communications and therefore was in a transition, during a period in which communication efforts and managing reputational risks was extremely important. Communications support	Mismatch between profiles and needs and lack of performance evaluations. There were some challenges related to the profile deployed. On assessments: the profile deployed had a humanitarian focus, while the CO would have needed a profile more focused on recovery. On communications, there were challenges in terms of Arabic language capacity and strategic communications. These matters resulted in outputs that did not fully meet quality expectations or the strategic needs of the Country Office. There is not a formal mechanism to assess the effectiveness and quality of SURGE deployments, particularly for internal UNDP staff. Feedback is shared informally, if at all, limiting

¹⁴ The measure was not approved when it was first requested by Lebanon, due to the outcome of the AAR for Afghanistan which stated as follows: “Fast Track approval made things move fast, but shorting advertising period resulted in low response from bidders, and low quality of bids. The better option to move the process faster would be to shorten the bid evaluation timeline instead of focusing much on the advertising period.” According to BMS, COs in crisis has been supported since then with the advice that if COs must reduce the bidding period, it should only be done on a case-by-case basis and only for off-the-shelf requirements that are readily available in the local market.

¹⁵ These were under development at the time of the Lebanon crisis and undergoing peer review. They have been later approved and now apply to all L-classified crises.

strengthened visibility, supported high level visits, and helped lay the groundwork for more structured communications planning. Early analytical and assessment support positioned UNDP as a credible knowledge partner in subsequent recovery planning processes. Overall, deployments contributed to longer term outcomes, including new funding and longer term capacity plans.	opportunities for organisational learning and improvement.
Strong contextual fit where relationships already existed. In mine action, longstanding institutional relationships with Lebanon's national mine action authority enabled the SURGE advisor to be effective quickly. Familiarity with national counterparts and sector dynamics facilitated trust, coordination and access, allowing UNDP to move beyond ad hoc support toward more strategic engagement.	Fragmentation and lack of continuity. Corporate support was provided initially in remote form (due to several factors including access to the country, availability of employees, logistics arrangements) and later through deployments, with some weeks in between. These gaps reduced momentum, made handovers less effective, and limited the ability to sustain strategic progress. After the deployments ended there were also gaps (for example, in the recruitment of the Head of Communications, or for a consultant on mine action support, which in the end was not hired). Clear continuity or transition plans were not always in place at the end of deployments, and are not required in SURGE ToRs.
Smooth deployment process. Across deployments, the professionalism of SURGE advisors were consistently highlighted. Processes for requesting and contracting SURGE support were described as smooth, reflecting strong collaboration between the Country Office and central bureaux. Good corporate support to employees was reported, including caring for the human being beyond their professional responsibilities.	Operational readiness. As SURGE support is limited in time, maximum efficiency would require that they are operational from the first day. A standard onboarding process could be developed by the CB and implemented together with the relevant CO. Some employees reported challenges in navigating some logistics and administrative arrangements on arrival.

RESOURCE MOBILIZATION AND PARTNERSHIPS

Overall, the CO was able to mobilize approximately US\$ 50,5 million for the crisis response and stabilization (including internal resources provided via TRAC3 and Funding Windows), which is a substantial achievement in the current funding climate. In the last years, the CO has consistently achieved and surpassed its resource mobilization target:

Year	Contributions target	Resources mobilized	%
2023	117.26 million	148.91 million	127%
2024	43.61 million	78.57 million	180%
2025	53,16 million	78.93 million (to date)	148%

A table with details of funds received for the crisis response and stabilization is available in [Annex 5](#).

Enabling factors	Challenges
Catalytic use of TRAC3 and Funding Windows. The Crisis Board allocated US\$ 1.2 million in TRAC3 for the crisis response, in addition to an earlier US\$ 170,000 allocation for DRM support. These flexible, early funds were used for aid coordination, assessments and critical programmatic interventions. They played a clear catalytic role: by enabling visible support to civil defense, DRM, mine action and security, they demonstrated UNDP's ability to deliver in a difficult environment and helped unlock further funding from bilateral donors. Funding Window resources were also released (later) for the crisis response and for the stabilization project. The strategic combination of TRAC,	Highly competitive global crisis environment. Lebanon crisis unfolded in a context of multiple competing emergencies and global funding cuts. Donors were cautious about scaling up beyond existing levels of support, and in some cases opted to prioritize other contexts. Korea, for example, shifted focus away from Lebanon partly because it was perceived as relatively well funded. Others may have redirected to crisis response funds that were already destined to Lebanon but to other initiatives; as a result, the overall portfolio has not significantly expanded (in fact, the annual delivery target has remained relatively constant between 2023 and 2025, between US\$ 72 and 80 million).

Funding Windows and reprogrammed resources allowed UNDP to scale up existing engagements, and to position itself as a solid partner for stabilization and recovery.	
Strong country presence, capacities, access and relationships. The CO has strong internal capacities and the vast majority of resource mobilization efforts were led by the CO itself. Moreover, the CO has a robust presence and access across Lebanon, it benefits from longstanding relationships with national and local authorities, and from in-house technical expertise in key areas linked to the crisis. This allowed UNDP to rapidly repurpose existing programmes, negotiate donor flexibility, and present itself as a partner able to operate even under movement restrictions and insecurity, despite the access challenges. These attributes likely increased donor confidence and facilitated the mobilization of funds.¹⁶ UNDP's comparative advantage as a stabilization and early recovery actor, bridging humanitarian response and development, was also an enabling factor.	Fragmented corporate resource mobilization architecture. Key informants have observed that responsibility for crisis-related corporate resource mobilization was distributed among multiple roles until very recently; some time after the start of the Lebanon crisis a dedicated Crisis node and partnership lead has been established for coordinating support to partnerships and communications. According to key informants, the coordination of corporate RM efforts across different Bureaux and organizational levels is a welcome development. The CO handled the vast majority of RM efforts, while BERA provided coordination capacity and support to donor's engagement, focusing in particular on GFFO through its Berlin representation office, and on France and Switzerland. The "Crisis Response & Stabilization Package" was used <i>in lieu</i> of a formal donor engagement strategy, which is required according to the SOPs
Strategic and well-timed engagement with Germany on stabilization. UNDP's agreement with Germany on the SRM dates from October 2023; therefore in 2024 UNDP was already in dialogue with a key donor on a relevant instrument. Negotiations with Germany on a possible stabilization project in Lebanon started immediately when a window opened after the cessation of hostilities. At the same time, the CO had already been working on a stabilization approach, and it was open about access and capacity constraints, which helped addressing the donor's doubts on the challenging implementation context. Institutional knowledge and personal relationships were important enabling factors: senior staff who knew both Lebanon and stabilization, and a former Resident Representative heading the Berlin office, were able to knit together country-level evidence, corporate positioning and donor priorities in a compelling way, which led to a first SRM allocation of US\$ 3 million while ensuring coordination with the existing substantial BMZ/KfW portfolio .	Donors' internal coordination. Challenges emerged when trying to complement and sequence funding from GFFO and KfW/BMZ, as complex negotiations emerged between the two German entities on funding activities in Lebanon. This delayed the start of the stabilization project and forced UNDP to allocate additional US\$ 935,000 to activities in Pillars 2 and 3 of the project to ensure its full implementation, necessary for a successful application of the stabilization approach
UNDP's positioning and communication at corporate level. UNDP is perceived by many partners as a strong actor on stabilization and early recovery, particularly in linking humanitarian and development efforts. This reputation was reinforced by multiple donor briefings in New York and the Administrator's participation in the Paris Conference, where substantial pledges were secured. BERA contributed by organizing briefings with permanent missions and supporting corporate messaging on Lebanon. This enhanced UNDP's visibility and credibility.	
Donor flexibility and Lebanon's priority status. Despite competing crises, Lebanon remains a priority country for many donors, according to key informants. Several donors showed flexibility in allowing reprogramming and	

¹⁶ Due to the light nature of the AAR, donors were not interviewed; however we can reasonably infer their trust in UNDP by the amount of resources allocated to the crisis response and stabilization programmes.

geographic retargeting of existing funds toward crisis affected areas	
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GOOD PRACTICES AND LESSONS LEARNED

The experience in Lebanon can be distilled into some good practices:

Trust-based delegation to a high-capacity Country Office	Where a Country Office has demonstrated leadership, political acuity and crisis experience, early delegation of authority and operational autonomy can significantly enhance speed and effectiveness. In Lebanon, corporate trust allowed rapid decision-making without micromanagement, while maintaining strong political and technical backing. Effective support from Crisis Bureau, RBAS, BMS and BERA added value when aligned behind CO leadership and adapted to evolving needs. It should be noted that this is replicable only where CO capacity and leadership are demonstrably strong; it is not a default model for all crisis contexts.
Reinforcing national coordination systems rather than creating parallel structures.	Supporting and strengthening an existing, functional, government-led coordination architecture (rather than introducing new cluster mechanisms) proved strategically sound. It preserved national ownership, reduced fragmentation and positioned UNDP at the centre of response planning through technical, behind-the-scenes support to the DRM unit. This approach requires a certain level of state functionality and capacity, and may not be applicable to all crisis contexts.
Framing crisis response, stabilization and recovery within a single strategic narrative	The “Crisis Response and Stabilization Package” provided a coherent programmatic and resource mobilization frame, enabling UNDP to operate across the humanitarian-development nexus and maintain strategic clarity for donors and partners. It also provided a framework for the reallocation of existing funding, and the strategic allocation of internal skill capacities.
Prioritization of local expertise	The CO has given priority to hiring local experts to strengthen the office capacities where needed, with the multiple positive effects of ensuring faster deployments, localizing the response, and reducing costs. Whenever the national expertise is sufficient, this is recommended as the default approach.

The experience has also proportioned some lessons:

Donor architecture risks must be anticipated and actively managed	While internal fragmentation within donor systems cannot be managed by UNDP, to mitigate risks an in-depth understanding of donor priorities and division of labour, and consequent positioning, are essential. UNDP should systematically assess donor risk appetite, internal coherence and sequencing constraints early in politically sensitive responses. Specifically in the case of stabilization programmes, the existing situation and donor landscape needs to be taken into account, as it might not be possible to sequence funding to ensure rapid stabilization first, followed by development financing to consolidate gains once conditions allow.
Rapid guidance is needed on evacuation and duty of care in high-risk contexts	The absence of a common UN approach to evacuation created uncertainty and burdened individual agencies. The increasing frequency of potential evacuation situations, with different interagency decisions (or lack thereof), underscores the need for practical scenario-based guidance for COs that balances duty of care with the imperative to stay and deliver.
Crisis programming and operational flexibility require mindset shift and experience, or training and preparedness	Crisis response and stabilization programming, as well as operational flexibility, require both a mindset change and experienced, proactive staff, as demonstrated by the Lebanon CO. For less experienced staff, both in COs and in centralized systems, investing in training and preparedness is fundamental, as flexibility alone will not be sufficient.

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

CONCLUSIONS

The corporate response was highly relevant and strategically well positioned, successfully leveraging UNDP's comparative advantage in state-led crisis response, stabilization, and early recovery. UNDP's focus on national institutions, coordination systems, and state authority matched the nature of the Lebanon crisis and clearly differentiated its role from humanitarian actors. The decision to reinforce existing government-led coordination mechanisms rather than introduce new cluster structures was strategically sound and preserved national ownership while consolidating UNDP's central role across response, stabilization, and recovery planning.

Timeliness was strong at the strategic and early operational levels, but diminished during the transition from crisis response to stabilization due to structural and donor-related constraints. Early actions – including anticipatory support to the DRM unit, rapid declaration of an L3 crisis, early TRAC3 allocations, fast activation of SM – enabled UNDP to move quickly and credibly. However, the intended speed advantage of stabilization programming through the SRM was partially lost due to donor internal coordination challenges, integration complexities with development financing, and continued insecurity.

Strategic decision-making benefited from a high-trust, decentralized corporate model that empowered a strong Country Office while providing timely political, technical, and operational backing. Corporate decisions to delegate authority and avoid micromanagement enabled agility, political sensitivity, risk-informed programming, and effective leveraging of corporate tools. The effectiveness of this approach, however, was contingent on the CO's demonstrated leadership, crisis experience, and operational maturity, so it cannot be universally applied in other crisis.

The integrated "Crisis Response and Stabilization Package" was an effective strategic framework for coherence, donor engagement, and internal alignment across crisis response, stabilization, and recovery. The package provided a clear narrative and structure linking assessments, programmatic shifts, stabilization logic, and resource mobilization. It enabled UNDP to present a credible, evidence-based offer to donors and to internally align multiple funding streams (TRAC3, Funding Windows, reprogrammed resources).

Resource mobilization was effective and catalytic, and relied heavily on Country Office capacity. The conversion of approximately US\$2.3M in early funding into over US\$50M for crisis response and stabilization demonstrates strong effectiveness, especially in a constrained global funding environment. This success was driven by the CO's capacity, credibility, analytical products, and donor relationships. Corporate RM support added value in positioning and visibility in accordance with the SOPs and CPCAP, noting that a stronger, more systematic corporate engagement in crisis-related RM would have been beneficial. This issue has been now addressed with a Partnership Node within BERA.

Operational effectiveness was high overall, but some bottlenecks in HR surge, procurement thresholds, and SURGE deployment continuity constrained full responsiveness. Special Measures, experienced operations staff, and proactive risk management enabled continuity and delivery under conflict conditions. However, delays in HR processes through GSSC, limited delegation for non-staff recruitment, procurement constraints at country level, and uneven SURGE profile matching reduced the efficiency gains expected from existing crisis mechanisms.

Gender equality and surge deployment practices reveal gaps in translating corporate commitments into practice. Despite strong policy commitments, some corporate requirements on gender (including the 15% GEN3 target) were not met across the response. Similarly, weaknesses in SURGE profile matching, continuity planning, and performance evaluation constrained impact, and improvement opportunities.

RECOMMENDATIONS

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE CRISIS BUREAU

Recommendation 1: Refine the SRM operational model. Revise SRM processes to clarify sequencing with development financing, establish time benchmarks from political window opening to project start, to ensure the rapid nature of the stabilization model is fulfilled, and ensure close collaboration with BERA to address donor sensitivities.

Recommendation 2: Introduce mandatory performance and continuity requirements for SURGE deployments. A light but mandatory post-deployment review should be introduced to assess relevance, profile fit, quality of outputs, and lessons learned, regardless if the employee is UNDP staff, consultant, or a secondment from another agency. Include in SURGE TORs a standard deliverable for 'continuity plan' or 'exit strategy'.

Recommendation 3: Conduct a cost-benefit or cost-effectiveness analysis across the last/next 7-10 crisis responses on the deployment of SURGE international staff, compared to national experts with similar skills and ToRs, using common metrics across responses, to choose the best approach for future deployments to support COs in crisis.

Recommendation 4: In collaboration with BMS, develop practical guidance on evacuation. Develop a scenario-based guidance for COs related to evacuation. Highlight different situations including joint UN decision, absence of a joint UNCT decision, ambiguous scenarios. The guidance should bring together all relevant security and safety regulations, HR, administrative, logistical, financial, and other implications. Highlight critical considerations, decision-making roles and responsibilities, duty of care for staff, consideration on operational continuity, and other relevant aspects. Disseminate to COs and Regional Bureaux.

Recommendation 5: Replicate standard emergency practice and develop Crisis Preparedness Plans. As UNDP becomes more and more involved in crisis response, it would benefit from replicating standard practices of other experienced humanitarian organizations. One of these is the mandatory development and implementation of Crisis preparedness plan (CPP) for COs above a certain risk threshold. An emergency preparedness plan will identify risk scenarios, a response plan with specific activities and targets, based on UNDP crisis response packages and programmatic, operational and coordination requirements, needs for additional HR, supplies if relevant, minimum funding and contingency resources. It should be noted that the EPP is different from the Business Continuity Plan (BCP).

Recommendation 6: Conduct a refresher training to all CO (particularly Project/Programme Managers) on the Gender Marker Guidance Note to ensure accurate and consistent scoring of project outputs related to gender equality

Recommendation 7: Develop enforcing mechanisms to ensure the implementation of the 15% allocation of crisis resources to GEN3 outputs

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR BERA

Recommendation 1: Maintain proactive corporate RM engagement in L3 crises, even where CO capacity is strong. Provide support in line with the crisis SOPs and guidelines, and as determined by the CO, including support in the development of crisis-specific donor engagement strategies aligned with CO-led frameworks, in collaboration with the newly established Partnership Lead, and early-stage donor intelligence and risk analysis for stabilization funding.

Recommendation 2: Ensure coordination of crisis communications support follows the Crisis SOPs. Streamline internal coordination for crisis communications to avoid overload of CO with inputs or requests, by strengthening a single, crisis-specific communications coordination mechanism, responsible for aligning HQ, regional, and CO messaging, and ensuring consistency between advocacy, RM narratives, and operational realities. The single point of entry to the CO (as per Crisis SOPs) is the recommended course of action.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR BMS

Recommendation 1: In collaboration with the Crisis Bureau, develop practical guidance on evacuation. Develop a scenario-based guidance for COs related to evacuation (based on the Security Policy Manual). Highlight different situations including joint UN decision, absence of a joint UNCT decision, ambiguous scenarios. The guidance should bring together in the same place all relevant security and safety regulations, HR, administrative, logistical, financial, and other implications and highlight critical considerations, decision-making roles and responsibilities, duty of care for staff,

consideration on operational continuity, and other relevant aspects, for rapid consultation in critical, rapidly evolving security situations. Disseminate to COs and Regional Bureaux.

Recommendation 2: Strengthen Special Measures implementation. Strengthen capacities of COs and GCCS on Special Measures, to ensure they are well known and fully applied when activated. After one year of implementation of the SM, conduct a revision of their application and if relevant, consider adding or modifying existing provisions, including reviewing delegation thresholds for non-staff recruitment, procurement solicitation periods, and payment approvals in L3 contexts, with a view to increasing country-level authority where risk is manageable.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR LEBANON COUNTRY OFFICE

Recommendation 1: Strengthen gender responsiveness beyond mainstreaming by increasing targeted GEN3 interventions in crisis portfolio. While gender is well recognized institutionally, and the CO overall integrates gender considerations into the majority of its work, the CO should ensure that all its knowledge products are gender-sensitive, especially assessments for the importance they bear on the development of future programmes. Moreover, the CO should ensure internal GEN3 allocations across crisis programmes to reach established corporate thresholds. Engage corporate support from the outset on gender equality, to ensure the Gender Marker is applied correctly and consistently.

Recommendation 2: Develop a crisis preparedness plan for likely risk scenarios, and operating under heightened security and access constraints. Given the frequency of crises in Lebanon, develop a programmatic, operational and coordination preparedness plan including risk scenario, activities and targets, required HR, supplies and funding resources, for immediate translation to a response plan in case risks materialize. The plan shall work in coordination with the Business Continuity Plan the CO already has.

ANNEXES

ANNEX 1 - TORS OF THE CONSULTANCY

TERM OF REFERENCE

After Action Review for UNDP's Response to Crises in Lebanon, Sudan and Syria

GENERAL INFORMATION

Services/Work Description: Individual Consultancy

Project/Program Title: UNDP's Crisis Bureau

Post Title: After Action Review for UNDP's Response to Lebanon, Syria and Sudan Crises

Duty Station: home based **Duration:** 30 days (10 consultancy days per country: Lebanon, Syria, and Sudan)

Expected Start Date: 12th November 2025

Expected End Date: 30th May 2026

I. BACKGROUND / PROJECT DESCRIPTION

Crisis Bureau After Action Reviews (AARs):

UNDP carries out After Action Reviews as structured reflections after a crisis to help the organization identify strengths and weaknesses, positive and negative lessons learned, how to sustain what was done well and identify areas for improvement with a particular focus on the Crisis Bureau response. The AAR formulates actionable recommendations for improving UNDP crisis response policy and practice. As per the corporate accountability framework for crisis response, the UNDP Crisis Bureau leads the planning, coordination, roll out and dissemination of corporate AARs.

Crisis Background

Lebanon Crisis: In October 2023, hostilities between Hezbollah and Israel erupted, triggered by the Gaza war. Fighting escalated sharply in September 2024, when Israel killed Hezbollah's leader Hassan Nasrallah and intensified airstrikes across southern Lebanon, Beirut's southern suburbs, and the Bekaa. A ceasefire was brokered in November 2024. The conflict caused extensive destruction, particularly in the South of Lebanon: over 64,000

ANNEX 2 - METHODOLOGY

UNDP's response to the crisis was examined reflecting on the following key questions and sub-questions:

Questions	Sub-questions
Overall Clarity and Timeliness of Decision Making for the Response	Examine the timeliness and effectiveness of strategic decisions and actions taken by HQ, Regional Hub and the CO
	Examine UNDP's ability to take on a " whole of UNDP " approach to the response efforts
	Assess the compliance with UNDP's Crisis Response and Recovery SOPs and Supplementary Protocols in decision-making processes and in the response as a whole
	Assess how UNDP corporate technical and programmatic expertise was leveraged to support the CO's crisis response
	Assess how UNDP corporate technical and programmatic expertise was leveraged to support the CO's programmatic positioning
Timeliness and Effectiveness of Programmatic Response and the use of Corporate Funds	Review the pertinence and timeliness of UNDP's programmatic response and use of corporate funds (TRAC 3 and Funding Windows), especially focusing on how the CB support was used catalytic for the expansion and sustainability of crisis response and recovery
	Assess the extent to which the (corporate funded) crisis programmes were gender responsive .
	Examine how adjustments were made to the ongoing projects in response to the crisis (including the identification of new programmes).
	Examine the timeliness and usefulness of key assessments/analysis conducted (including if applicable RAPIDA, housing and building damage assessments (HBDA), socio-economic impact analysis (SEIA), the PDNA/RDNA, etc.)
Effectiveness of the Operational Response	Review the timeliness and effectiveness of the overall operational response
	Review the effectiveness and cost-efficiency of SURGE deployments (including gender balance, any surge deployment on gender equality and women's empowerment, management of SURGE advisors in the country, collaboration between SURGE advisors and the country office team)
Resource Mobilization and Partnerships	Review UNDP's resource mobilization effectiveness , and joint work with partners

The light AAR is articulated in four phases to respond to the questions outlined: inception, data collection, analysis and reporting.

1. Inception

The inception phase included a brief desk review of key documents provided by the Crisis Bureau, as well as initial discussions with selected key informants. The purpose of the inception phase was to identify key priorities for the AAR, to focus subsequent data collection. The inception phase ended with the Inception Report (IR).

2. Data Collection

The data collection phase comprised a more in-depth desk review including further documentation provided by the CO, Crisis Bureau, RBAS and others and identification of key stakeholders for remote Key Informant Interviews (KII).

Desk review – Documents collected during the initial desk review are included in Annex 7 – Bibliography. Additional documents were identified and reviewed during the data collection phase.

Key informants were interviewed online using a simple guideline aimed at prompting reflection and discussion on the key aspects of UNDP crisis response. The table in Annex 3 indicates the informants interviewed. Key informants were consulted according to the main areas of inquiry and their role in each aspect of the response. The AAR ensured a gender-balanced approach to key informant interviews (12 female and 10 male informants were interviewed).

3. Analysis

After the data collection, in the analysis phase all information captured through the desk review, interviews, group discussion was triangulated and analyzed according to the four main subjects of the AAR. The analysis of the crisis response was conducted against criteria of pertinence, timeliness, efficiency, and effectiveness, to understand what worked well and what could have been done better or differently, according to the AAR methodology. As the AAR is not an evaluation there was not an assessment of the impact of UNDP's interventions. A focus on gender equality was maintained throughout the AAR, answering a specific sub-question that looks at assessing the extent to which the (corporate funded) crisis programmes were gender responsive, and assessing the inclusion of gender-responsive aspects in SURGE deployments. Lessons learned and good practices were identified and included in the analysis and AAR report.

4. Reporting

A draft report was produced and shared with key UNDP stakeholders for comments and observations, as well as validation of findings and recommendations. After review from UNDP a final AAR report will be elaborated (maximum 12 pages, without annexes), together with a 2-page summary and a slide deck for presentation to key stakeholders.

LIMITATIONS: the AAR has been allocated approximately 10 days – due to financial constraints affecting UNDP like many other organizations in the current global funding crunch; the limited time available has severely constrained the data collection phase (reduced to 3 days, compared to the 10 days of previous comparable AARs conducted by this consultant) forcing a severe reduction in the number of interviewees. Internal key informants have been prioritized for their extensive knowledge of UNDP processes, challenges and results; however external inputs would be useful for a broader analysis of the UNDP response. It is recommended that the AARs are returned to the previous timeframe of approximately 30 days for an in-depth analysis of responses.

ANNEX 3 - LISTS OF KEY INFORMANTS

The staff consulted for the AAR includes:

Name	Function	M/F
Lebanon CO		
Blerta Aliko	Resident Representative	F
Thair Shraideh	Deputy Resident Representative	M
Rowaida Khalife	Operations Manager	F
Elina Silen	Former Team Leader, Strategic Planning & Policy Unit (currently Regional Programme Manager, RBAS)	F
Antje Kraft	LAF Support Project Manager	F
Edgard Chehab	Head, Performance Management Unit	M
Nour Stephan	Project Assistant	F

Nino Karamaoun	Chief Technical Advisor, Rule of Law	M
Jinan Chinder	Area Manager – South Lebanon	F
Mariam Balhas	Gender Focal Point	F
Mohammad Assad	Admin-Finance Associate	M
Regional and HQ Bureaux		
Hiroshi Kuwata	Team Leader – Arab States (C3RT)	M
Roxanne Lette	Crisis Response Analyst (C3RT)	F
Rekha Das	Former Team Leader – Arab States	F
Glaucia Boyer	Global Advisor on Reintegration	F
Kiye Mwakawago	Project Manager, Crisis Bureau	M
Navindra Persaud	Programme Specialist, Crisis Bureau	M
Anna Vitkova	Regional Specialist, RBAS	F
Ahmad Alhammal	Regional Advisor, RBAS	M
Safaa Getzinger	Senior Programme Analyst	F
Patrick Nicholson	SURGE – Communications	M
Stephen Robinson	SURGE – Mine Action	M

ANNEX 4 - SPECIAL MEASURES

The table below shows the special measures approved for Lebanon and their use.

Measure Details	Category	# Cases	Value \$	Outcome (Narrative on usefulness or limitations)
Approval to advertise all national and international positions as internal and external vacancies simultaneously, while every effort will be made to ensure outreach to internal candidates.	Human Resources	1	236.300,00	This provision was valuable as it enabled the CO to save time by avoiding the need to post internally, wait for longlisting, and then proceed to external posting. It expanded the applicant pool to include qualified candidates from both inside and outside the organization, while still prioritizing internal applicants. Ultimately, a displaced internal applicant was selected for the position. The position was Procurement Specialist P4 fixed term appointment for the duration of 1 year with proforma cost equivalent to \$236,300
Devolution of Recruitment cases for local staff (in UNDP and Agencies) on exceptional basis to the local HR team in the country office		12	287.901,00	Of the 12 cases managed, 2 were directly related to UNDP, while the remaining 10 were handled by UNDP locally on behalf of UNOCHA. Having this provision in place proved beneficial, as it allowed us to prioritize and complete the recruitment processes swiftly and efficiently. The 2 positions related to UNDP were Programme Specialist NOC fixed term appointment for the duration of 1 year with proforma cost equivalent to \$190,546 and SIOC Operator G55 fixed term appointment for the duration of 1 year with proforma cost equivalent to \$97,355.
A waiver of the “expected duration of assignment” requirements stipulated in the Recruitment and Selection Framework for internal candidates to international FTA positions to increase the talent pool and consider such applicants. Based on organizational need and discretion, any intent to select and appoint a candidate who does not meet such time-inpost requirement will be reviewed by the Regional Bureau for a fast-track clearance by OHR		0	-	This provision was not utilized.
Waiver of the provisions in the Mobility Policy restricting consecutive assignments in E duty stations to two rotations. This would allow the CO to consider experienced candidates from other hardship locations who have served two consecutive assignments		0	-	This provision was not utilized.
Fast-track reviews of procurement cases by RACP and ACP reviews in 2-business days from the date of submission, when the submission is complete and any questions from the Committee Secretariat is responded by the Country Office.	Procurement	8	Total value not available	Procurement for RPAs, RFP for consultancy and civil works. Fast-track reviews of procurement cases by RACP and ACP within two business days are highly beneficial for CO as they significantly reduce administrative process and accelerate project delivery, especially for time-sensitive activities. This mechanism ensures that procurement processes remain compliant while enabling quick contracting of vendors, thereby improving responsiveness to urgent operational needs and safeguarding UNDP’s credibility and compliance. By streamlining approvals without compromising due diligence, fast-track reviews enhance efficiency, support timely implementation, and strengthen UNDP’s ability to meet critical deadlines in various projects.
Reduction of required solicitation period for Procurement bids from fourteen to seven days.		0	-	This provision was not approved and therefore not utilized. Reducing the solicitation period for procurement bids from fourteen to seven days significantly accelerates the procurement cycle, enabling faster supplier engagement and timely delivery of goods and services for urgent, time-bound activities. This

				adjustment helps UNDP meet critical deadlines without compromising transparency or competitiveness, provided that solicitation documents are clear and comprehensive to allow suppliers to respond effectively within the shorter timeframe.
Extend the validity of the LTAs that are due to expire in the next 6 months for an additional 1year period, which will allow the procurement to focus on other activities.		19	3068860 (total value of LTAs for three years)	The 19 LTAs have been extended through No-Cost Extensions. This means that only the contract duration was extended, without any additional financial commitment or increase in the contract ceiling, as there was still an unutilized amount available under the original agreement. The total value of these LTAs over the three-year period are \$3,068,860.00. Extending the validity of LTAs expiring in the next six months for an additional year allows UNDP to maintain continuity with pre-qualified suppliers, avoid disruptions in critical procurement processes, and allow for time and resources to focus on urgent and strategic activities, without compromising compliance or efficiency.
Increase petty cash level to \$10,000 CO (PCF)	Finance	0	-	This provision was not utilized. A higher petty cash ceiling minimizes the need for frequent replenishments and allows handling of larger urgent payments that cannot be processed through normal EFT or cheque methods. Holding \$10,000 in cash at CO premises increases exposure to theft and security breaches. Additional UNDSS security measures and custodian responsibilities must be implemented to safeguard funds
Emergency USD Advance 25,000 in USD – CO.		0	-	This provision was not utilized. In contexts where electronic transfers are unreliable, having cash on hand allows the CO to meet immediate obligations, maintain credibility with suppliers, and avoid operational standstills. Holding \$25,000 in cash significantly increases exposure to theft and requires stringent UNDSS-approved security measures, including safes, restricted access, and armed transport for cash movement
Increase of invoice petty cash limit to 1,000 USD instead of 250 USD in CO and area offices		0	-	This provision was not utilized. Raising the petty cash invoice limit to USD 1,000 allows to process micro-purchases more effectively without resorting to lengthy procurement procedures. This is particularly beneficial for urgent operational needs such as ICT supplies, maintenance, and small-scale services. Increasing the limit introduces greater exposure to misuse or non-compliance with POPP and Internal Control Framework (ICF) standards. Enhanced monitoring and documentation are required to mitigate these risks.
Increase the liquidation period for Project Cash Advance (PCA) from 30 days to 60 days.		0	-	This provision was not utilized. Extending the liquidation period to 60 days provides COs and area offices more time to reconcile expenses for activities in remote or high-risk locations, where logistical challenges often delay submission of supporting documents. Longer liquidation periods can lead to delays in detecting discrepancies or misuse of funds. This increases exposure to compliance risks and may affect cash flow management for subsequent activities.

ANNEX 5 - RESOURCE MOBILIZATION

Overall, the CO mobilized approximately US\$ 50,5 millions for crisis response and stabilization:

Project Name	Donor	Amount	For other currencies, USD equivalent on 31.12.2024
Ahead of L3 declaration, for support to DRM Unit	TRAC 1.1.3	USD 170.000	170.000,00
Assessment, coordination, and initial response	TRAC 1.1.3	USD 1.200.000	1.200.000,00
Mitigating the impact of conflict escalation in Lebanon on social, economic, and institutional stability – Crisis Response and Stabilization programme	Government of Belgium	EUR 2.000.000	2.083.333,33
	Government of Switzerland (FDFA)	USD 199.965	199.965,00
	Government of France	EUR 1.000.000	1.041.666,67
	EU	USD 7.822.400	7.822.400,00
	ECHO/IOM	EUR 271.130	282.427,08
	FW GPCR	USD 49.999	49.999,00
	FW GPCR	USD 201.839	201.839,00
	FW GPCR	USD 2.413.643	2.413.643,00
LAF Livelihood Ecosystem Project	Government of France	EUR 3.000.000	3.125.000,00
	The Norwegian Ministry of Foreign Affairs	NOK 30.000.000	2.645.502,65
	The Government of Federal Republic of Germany	EUR 5.000.000	5.208.333,33
	Spain	EUR 3.000.000	3.125.000,00
	EU (FPI2)	USD 12.755.640	12.755.640,00
	Spain	EUR 3.000.000	3.125.000,00
Stabilization in South Lebanon	Government of Germany	USD 3.043.993	3.043.993,69
	UNDP Funding Window	USD 935.000	935.000,00
Lebanon Host Support Project (LHSP)	Republic of Korea	USD 1.000.000	1.000.000,00
			50.428.742,75

ANNEX 6 - SURGE DEPLOYMENTS

Three people were deployed to Lebanon CO:

Name	Specialty	Dates of deployment
Patrick Nicholson	Communications	5 February – 5 April 2025
Stephen Robinson	Mine Action	9 February – 6 April 2025
Simon Little	Assessments	25 February – 8 April (funded by Crisis Bureau) and 9 April – 23 April (CO-funded)

ANNEX 7 – SELECTED BIBLIOGRAPHY

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